

Ian Cowpar

Strategic operator | technical translator | AI as operating leverage | zero-translation systems

ian.cowpar@gmail.com | 351-235-0365 | linkedin.com/in/ian-cowpar | theunofficialleader.substack.com

SUMMARY

Strategic operator with 20+ years of experience translating between executive vision and ground-level execution. Two years at UKG operating at the seam between Product, Services, and Engineering during a multi-year \$250M ARR migration — coordinating cross-functional execution across 300 enterprise customers, scaling UKG product's first organized AI capability layer without a top-down mandate, and shipping a 0→1 product I wrote the working prototype for myself in Claude Code. Ten years prior at Broadridge Financial Solutions: 40+ enterprise client deployments in compliance-grade environments where regulatory consequence sharpened the synthesis, stakeholder-management, and operating-discipline instincts that translate directly to a Chief of Staff function.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR | Cross-functional execution, AI-fluent strategy, and operating discipline at the seam between Product, Services, and Engineering

- **Built UKG product's first organized AI capability layer.** Started as a personal automation library, scaled into team-wide shared capability without a top-down mandate. Adoption spread because the thing worked better than what it replaced — the only kind of adoption that lasts. Ran peer groups to make sure the practice stuck across the team.
- **Owned a 0→1 self-serve migration product, idea to production.** Took it from concept through three business-epic decomposition (UI, rules, deployment), wrote the working prototype myself in Claude Code, designed the UX feedback loop and persona, and handed engineering the full delivery package — bepics, epics, stories, Gantt, roadmap. Now in active production; the Services org runs migrations independently without an engineering ticket.
- **Partnered with the UTA upgrade program lead and engineering leadership on ARR-focused risk tracking** — designed the executive reporting cadence and routing logic that surfaced aging issues to leadership before they escalated. Built for the way executive stakeholders actually want to see a portfolio.
- **Served as the product-side voice on enterprise customer escalation and pre-upgrade calls** — synthesizing what 300 UTA customers (\$250M ARR) actually needed versus what was on the roadmap, feeding that gap back into prioritization decisions. The synthesis and exec-room composure that translate directly to a Chief of Staff function.
- **Designed and operationalized a five-panel operational analytics product** that surfaced a single highest-leverage action per panel across customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise — auto-refreshed daily across four products, with a Claude Code function I built into the tool to drive the leverage analysis. The system replaced manual feedback synthesis across multiple engineering leads.
- **Designed sprint health instrumentation across two engineering teams** to give engineering leadership a continuous view of delivery health, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns — each with technical rationale. Built for signal, not ceremony.

Drove cross-org collaboration as a regional brand champion (UKG North America) and Business Innovation workstream lead in the Fire Up ERG, building relationships with senior leaders across the org that translated into the cross-functional partnerships I relied on for delivery.

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Program owner across 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade financial services environment; developed strong instincts for regulatory consequence, requirements quality, multi-stakeholder coordination, and the difference between a delivery that closes and a program that keeps producing.
- Internal SME for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full client base; translated complex compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers and executives could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

AI as Co-Builder: Claude Code prototyping, agentic workflows, AI-fluent product development, PM automation, zero-translation building, enterprise AI adoption strategy

Strategy & Execution: Strategic initiative ownership, 0→1 product building, MVP definition, end-to-end delivery from prototype to production, complex program management, modern collaboration tooling

Compliance & Enterprise: Regulatory-consequence delivery, compliance-grade financial services, multi-stakeholder coordination, executive customer engagement, escalation room presence, exec-room synthesis

Data & Analytics: Operational analytics products, opinionated instrumentation, KPI definition, automated reporting cadence, qualitative-to-structured synthesis

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on AI adoption, unofficial leadership, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on enterprise AI adoption, executive technology strategy, and team dynamics.